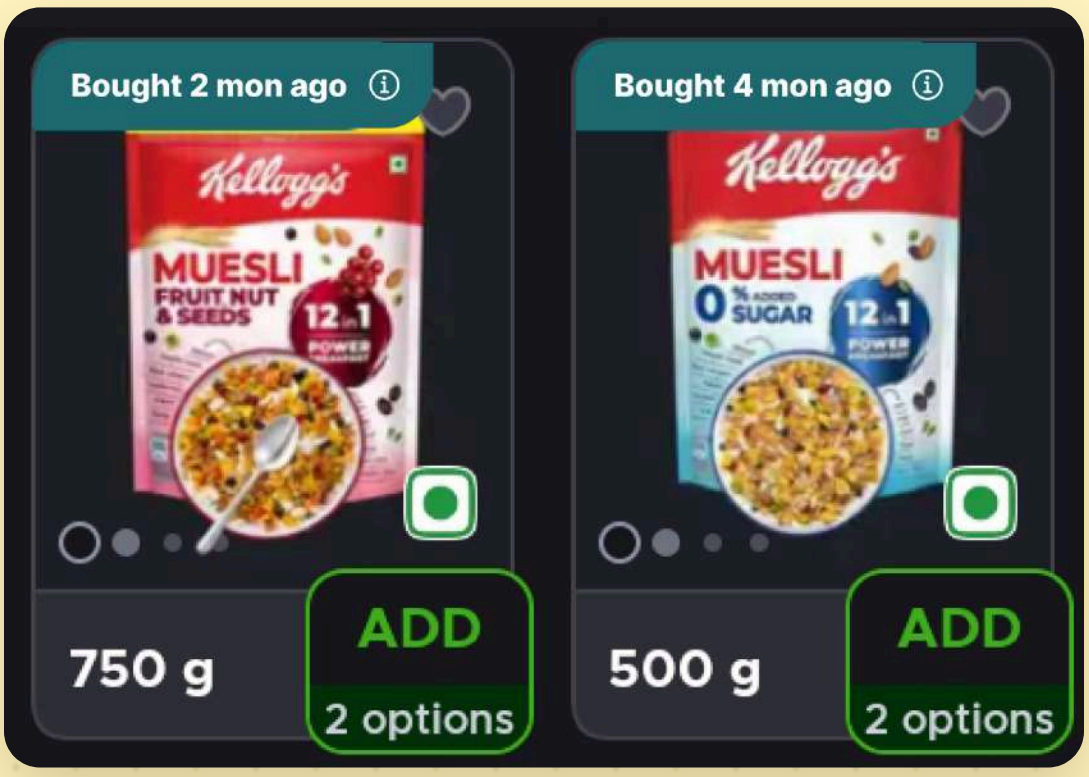
Blinkit · Retention case study

Timeline: 3 hours

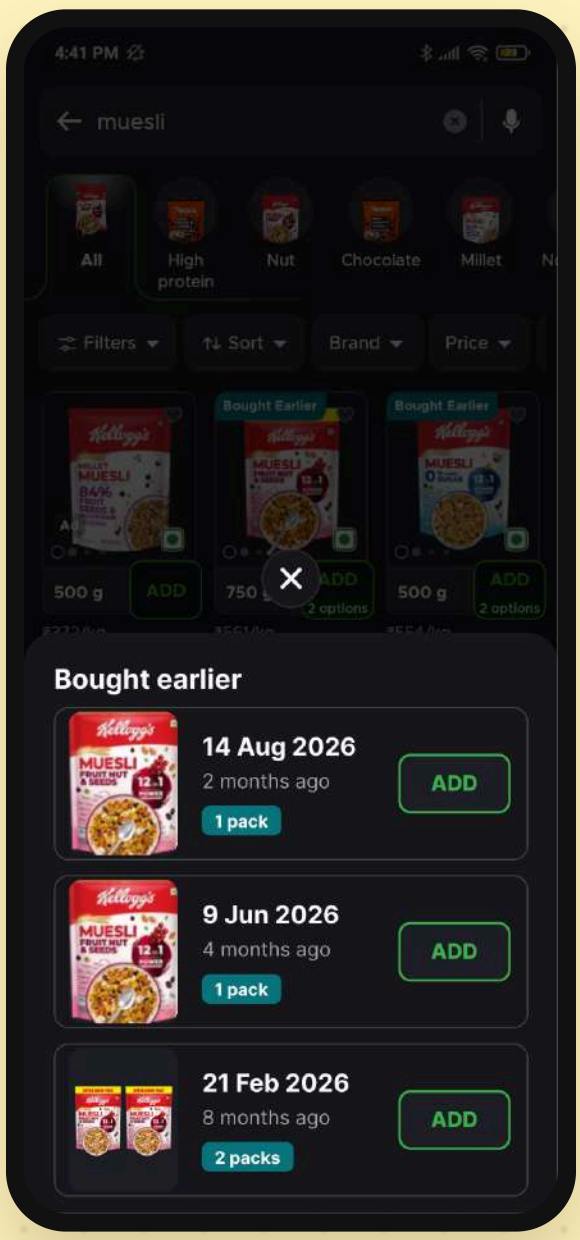
How do you rebuy the item you loved, when you can’t remember which one it was?

It’s been a long time. Since then you’ve bought many items of the same kind, and they all look alike. Now you want the exact one you loved back then.

You forgot which one. Blinkit didn’t.



The card shows when you last bought it

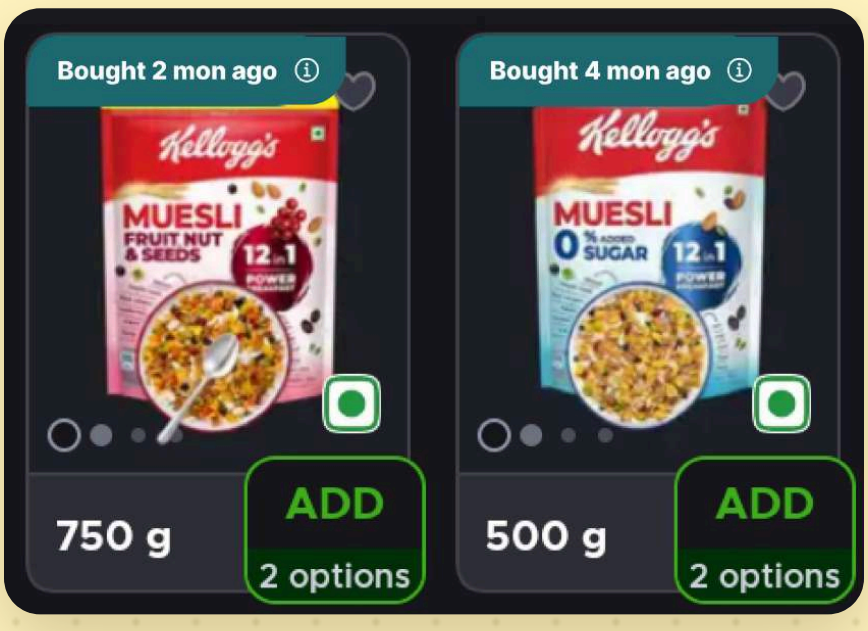


Tap it to see every past buy, and add

One small tag that remembers the exact product you loved

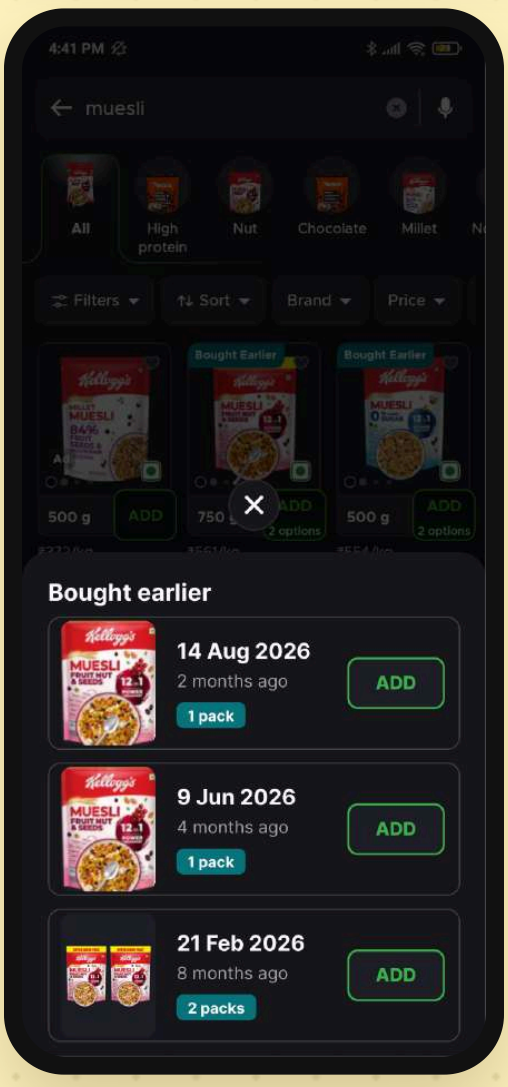
The product card shows when you last bought it. Tap the tag to see every past purchase, and add the right one from there.

Design decisions I made



The last bought date, right on the tag

“Bought earlier” becomes “Bought 2 mon ago”. Seen while scrolling, no tap needed. The date brings back the memory of the taste.



The full history, one tap away

Tap the tag to see every date, how long ago and how many packs. Repeat buys and 2 packs show which one they liked.

Add right inside the sheet

The moment they’re sure, they can buy. No going back to search.

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But how did I get here?

Let’s look at the process.

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It started with one number: retention

The business wanted people to keep coming back and have a great experience. So what makes a returning buyer stop? They come back for the exact item they loved long ago, can’t tell which one it is, and get stuck.

THE BRIEF · GROWTH GOAL

Increase the retention rate of Blinkit.

THE USER GOAL I FOUND

Buy the same product again, without having to remember which brand or item it was.

THE EXPERIENCE GOAL

How might we reassure returning buyers about what they bought before, so they can add it to cart quickly, without guessing or digging through order history?

But who exactly is this buyer? →

Two buyers. Only one of them is stuck.

ASSUMPTION

For clarity, I follow one journey: someone who wants to rebuy a muesli they loved long ago, but can’t remember which one. They have bought and tasted many mueslis on Blinkit. The same applies to any product people rebuy this way.

TARGET USER

People who buy many products and want one specific item right now.



Primary persona

Sunil, the forgetful explorer

Archetype: a frequent buyer who wants one exact item he bought before

- Tried many mueslis. Liked only one.
- Last bought it 3 months ago. Forgot the pack and the price.
- Needs to spot the one he liked and add it fast.



Secondary persona

Alok, the routine restocker

Archetype: a frequent buyer who buys the same things again and again

- Never explores. Needs no reminder.
- **Why him?** Buyers like Alok drive retention today. The solution must not slow them down.

Sunil’s hunt for “that one” muesli

Way 1 · Through the home page



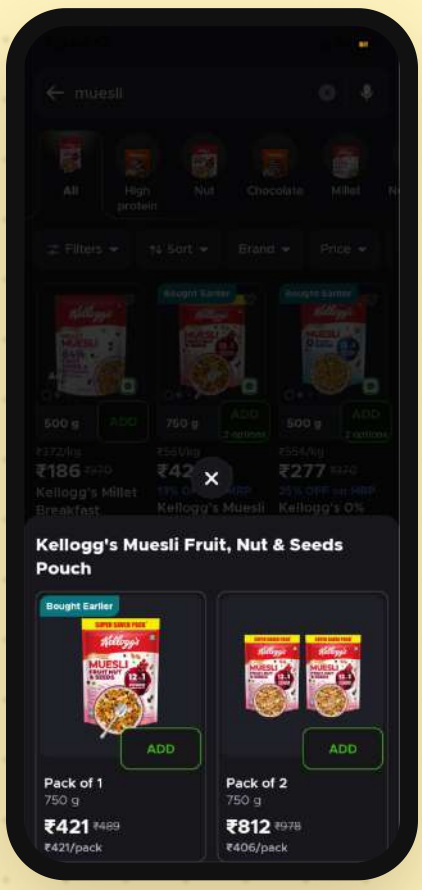
Opens Blinkit



Goes to Frequently bought, taps See all products



Finds 2 mueslis he bought before. Which one did he like?

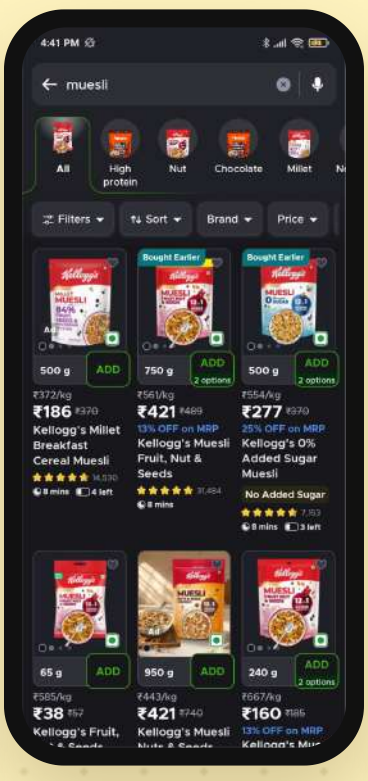


Picks one and adds. Still not sure

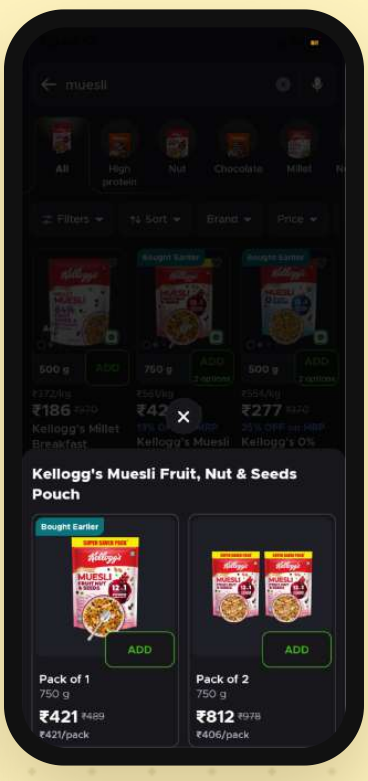
Way 2 · Through search



Opens Blinkit



Searches muesli. Can’t tell the 2 apart



Guesses and adds to cart

Pain point

Both ways end the same. He tries to recall from the pack picture, and still makes a guess.

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Alok needs no reminder. So don’t get in his way.

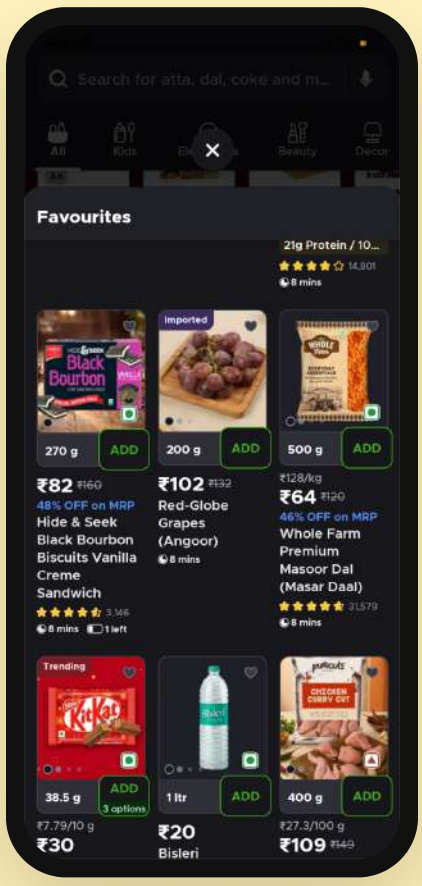
He knows what he buys. He goes straight to Favourites and restocks.



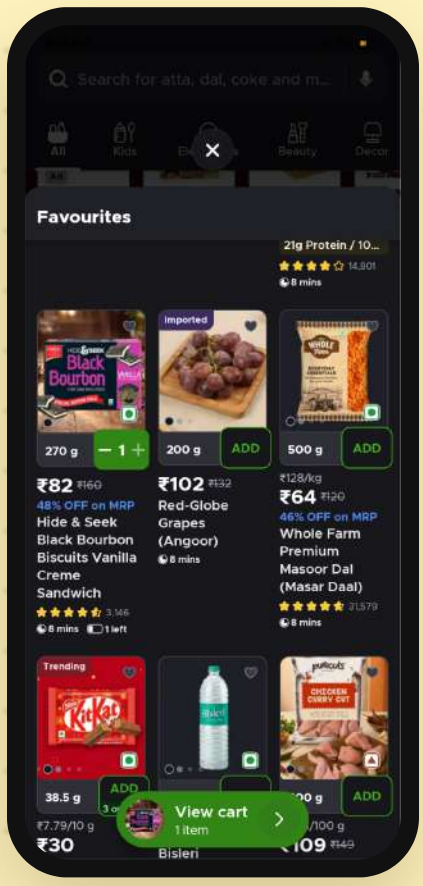
Opens Blinkit



Goes to Frequently bought



Opens Favourites, finds his biscuits



Taps Add and checks out

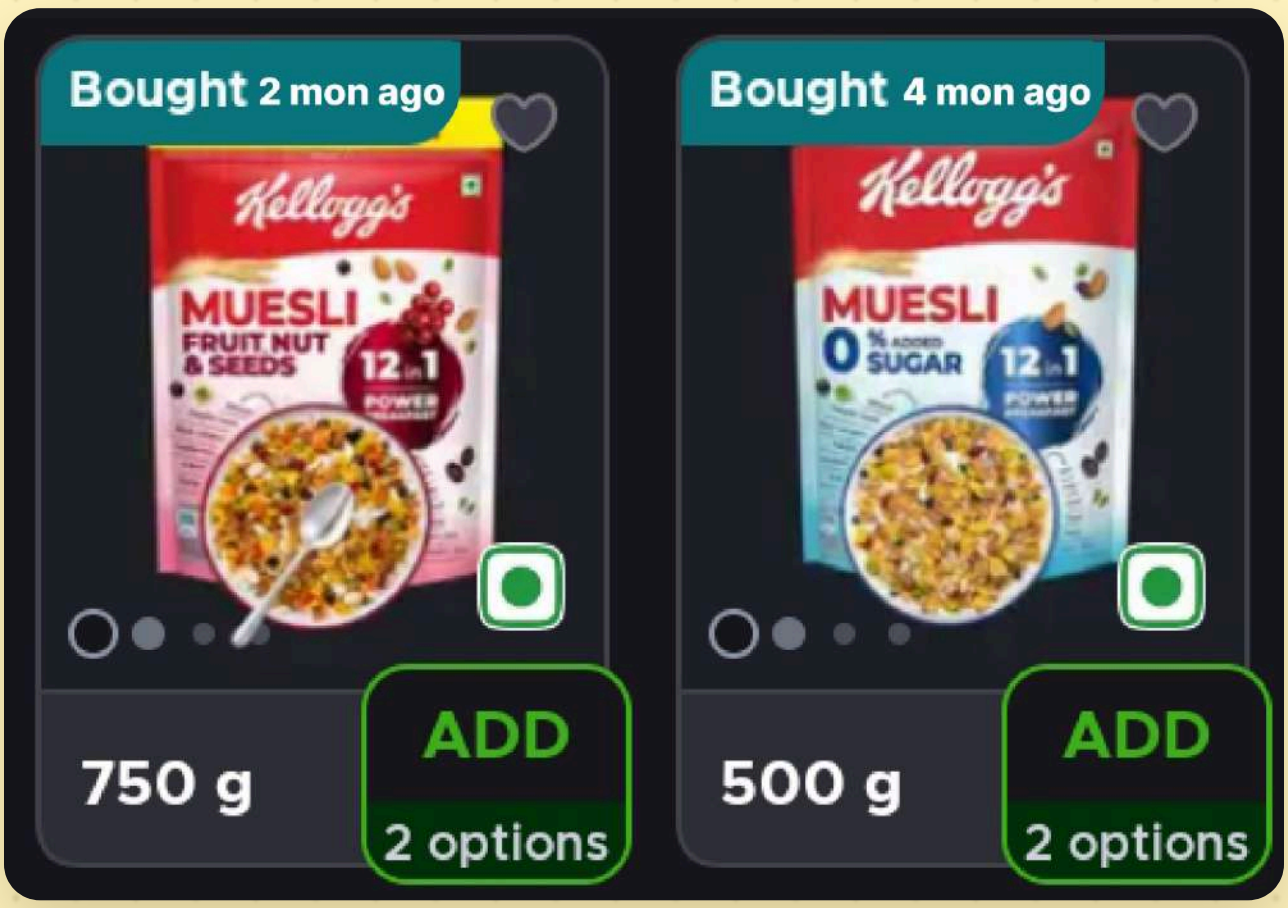
No pain point

And that’s the point. Any new step here would slow down the people who already keep Blinkit’s retention going.

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Idea 1 of 4

Let the date jog the memory



What it is

The tag shows when the item was bought last, like 2 mon ago.

Why it works

People remember when they bought something better than the pack or price. The date brings back the experience.

Where it falls short

Two items bought around the same time look alike. A very old date is too faint to help.

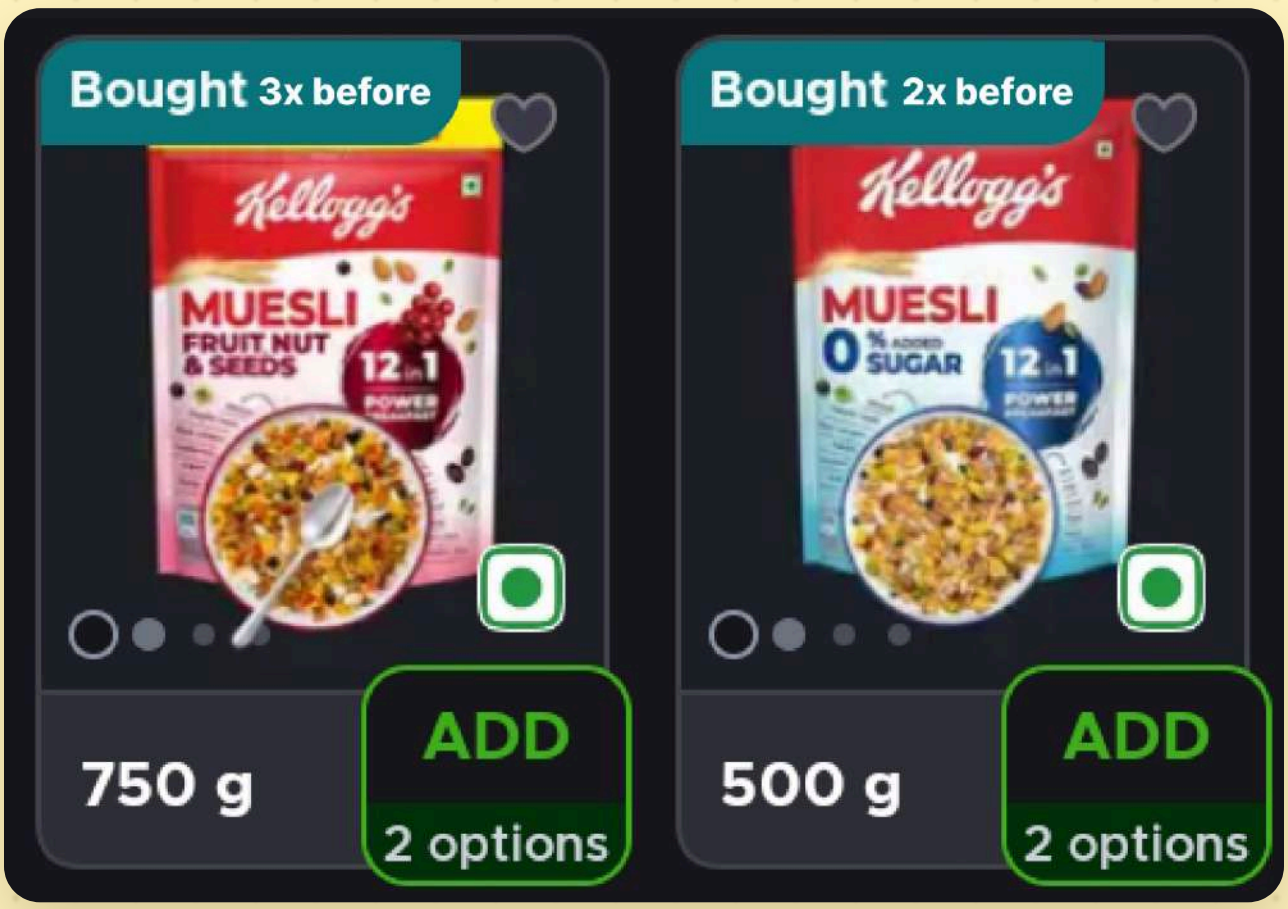
My decision

Keep the date, but it needs backup for these cases. Not enough alone.

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Idea 2 of 4

Count how often they came back



What it is

The tag shows how many times the item was bought, like 3x before.

Why it works

Buying again is a strong sign of liking it. Suits routine buyers like Alok.

Where it falls short

A higher count can just mean a discount. For Sunil, who tried each one once, all show 1x.

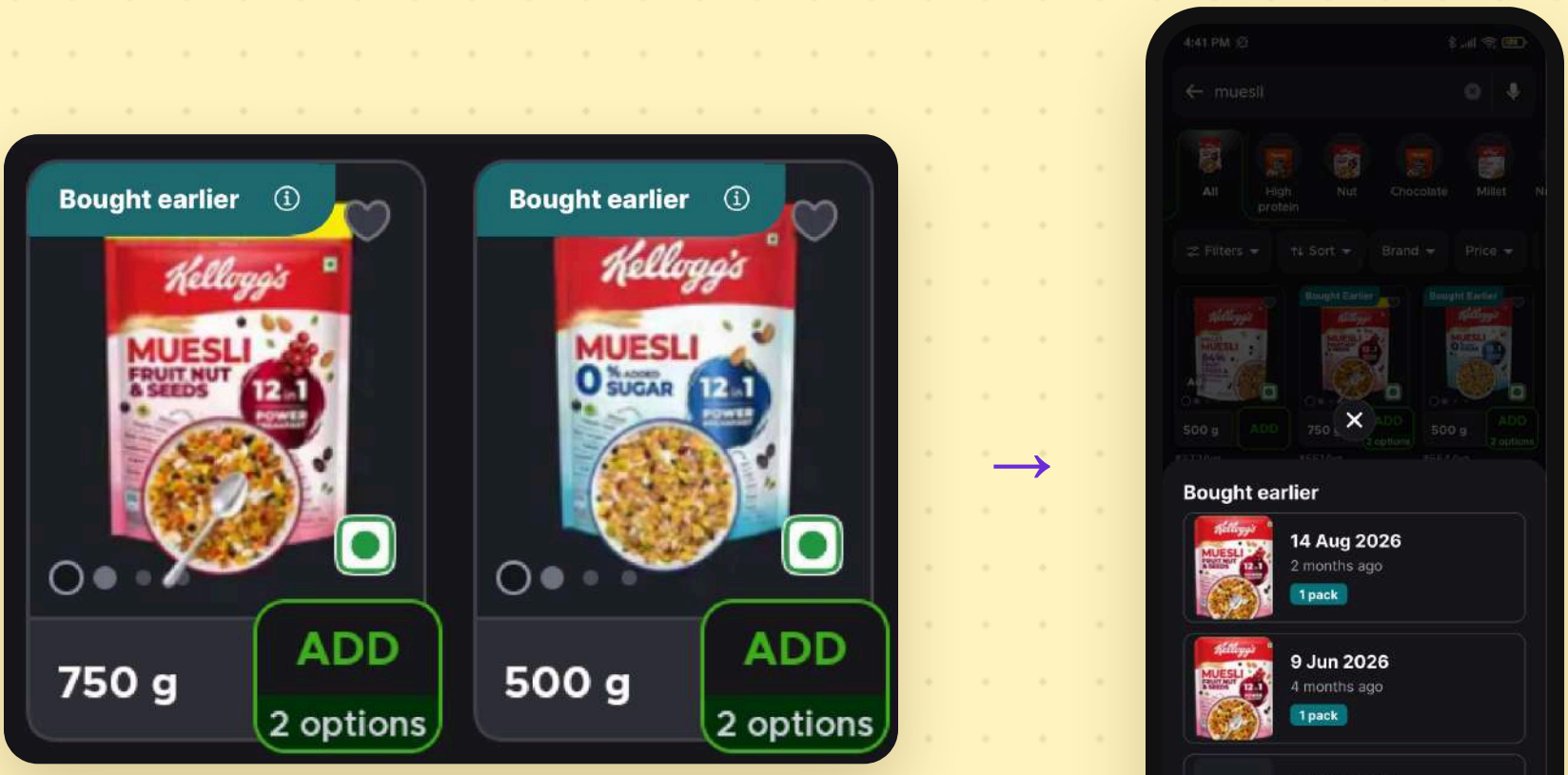
My decision

Dropped it. A count can mislead, and it doesn't help the primary persona.

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Idea 3 of 4

Show the whole story behind the tag



What it is

Tap the “Bought earlier” tag to open every past purchase: date, time ago, packs.

Why it works

The full picture. Rebuying the same item, or buying 2 packs, shows it was the one they liked.

Where it falls short

“Bought earlier” says nothing new, so the user must tap every time. The tiny ⓘ is a weak anchor: hard to notice, hard to tap, and nothing tells the user what tapping does. There’s no help or hint.

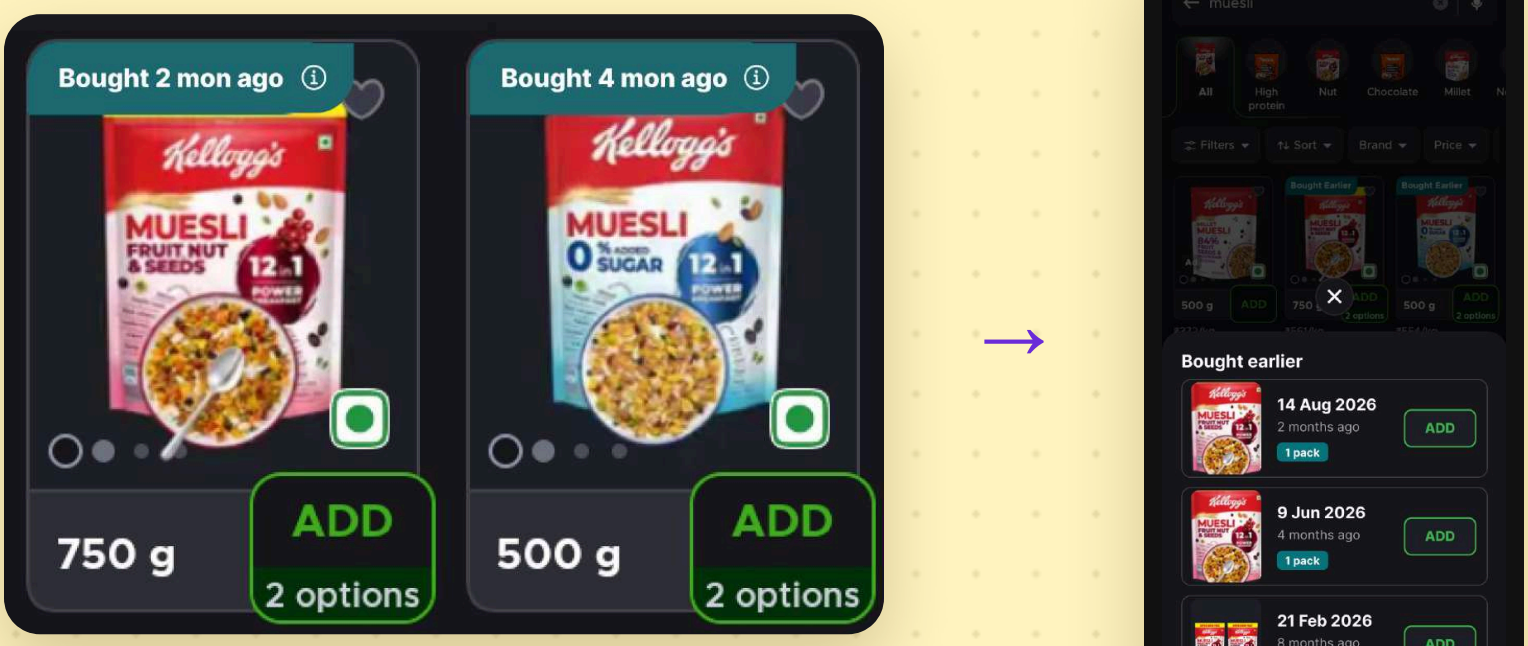
My decision

Keep the sheet, but not as the first thing the user must do.

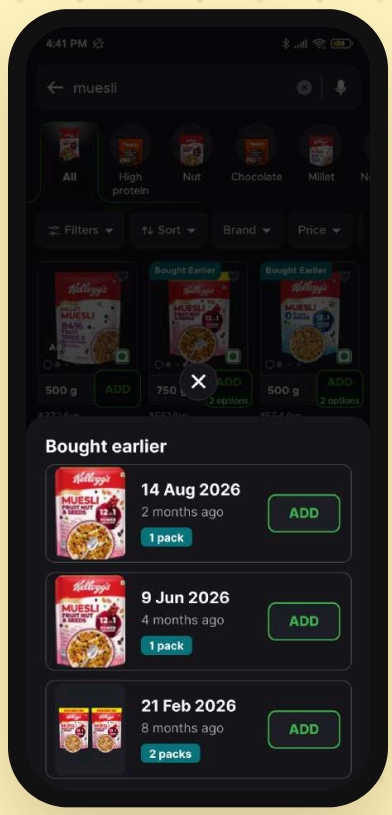
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Idea 4 · The strongest one

The date up front, the full story on tap



→



Design decisions

- Merged idea 1 and 3: quick hint on the card, details only when needed
- Add inside the sheet, so they buy the moment they're sure
- The whole tag is tappable. No ⓘ if bought only once
- Reuses Blinkit's existing tag. No new space

Why I chose it over ideas 1, 2 and 3

- "Bought 4 mon ago ⓘ" is a stronger anchor than "Bought earlier ⓘ"
- Idea 3 cost a tap for any info. Here the date alone brings back the memory. Tap only for the full history, saving a tap in most cases
- Works for both: Alok glances, Sunil taps
- Fixes idea 1's look-alike and old dates with the history
- Drops idea 2's misleading count
- Never tells them what to buy. It helps them remember, the choice stays theirs

How I’ll know it actually works

HOW I’LL RUN IT

An A/B test. Half of the returning users see the new tag, half see the current app.

Speed

- Time from search to adding a previously bought item, before vs after
- Fewer image swipes and product pages opened before adding

Picking the right item

- More users rebuy the item they bought most before
- Fewer returns or wrong item complaints

Use of the new parts

- How many open the history sheet, and how many add from it
- Fewer visits to order history to check past buys

Guardrail

- Quick restock buyers like Alok shouldn’t take longer to add to cart

Why they'll keep coming back to Blinkit

Blinkit remembers, so they don't have to

It keeps track of what they bought and when. No effort to recall which one it was.

The date takes them back

They may forget the taste or the product, but they remember when they had it.

It feels personal

The app knows them. That builds a quiet sense of safety: "Even if I forget, Blinkit will remind me."

So they return

Users who went away can rebuy the exact thing they loved, even after buying many similar options since, without guessing or going elsewhere.

Every right reorder is one more reason to stay

Even if they go away, or buy something now and want it again later, Blinkit will help them remember when they had it. That takes them back to the experience and gives them more markers to choose well.

Retention drives the business goal, which makes Blinkit stronger.

Blinkit does the remembering.
The user does the reordering.

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You can check out the entire work that I have done in my FigJam.

Open the FigJam file →

https://www.figma.com/board/V7EDon8FrT9Zh77y1ZPeSS/Mainakh_Blinkit-Retention?node-id=0-1